

Saghi Sarafi

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EDUCATION

University of New Mexico , Albuquerque, NM <i>PhD. Student in Geography and Environmental Studies</i> - GPA: 4.23 - Relevant coursework includes: Remote Sensing and Aerial Photos Analysis, Human Geography, Physical Geography, Socio-Ecological Systems, Geographic Theory and Methods, Map Use, Cartography, and Spatial Thinking	Exp. Dec 2030
Carinthia University of Applied Science , Villach, Austria <i>Master of Spatial Information Management</i> - GPA: 4.0/4.0 - Relevant coursework includes: Advanced Concepts and Applications of GIS, Geodata Integration, Statistical Spatial Analysis, Data Mining, Spatio-Temporal Databases, 3D Modeling and Spatio-Temporal Analysis and Modeling, GIS Services, and Geovisualization	March 2023
Yazd University , Yazd, Iran <i>Master of Urban Design</i> - GPA: 3.7/4.0 - Relevant coursework includes: Research Methodology, Humans and Environment, IT and Introduction to Urban Design Software, Urban Design Methods, Theoretical Foundations of Urban Design	March 2015
University of Kurdistan , Sanandaj, Iran <i>Bachelor of Urban Planning</i> - GPA: 3.3/4.0 - Relevant coursework includes: GIS, Remote Sensing and Aerial Photos Analysis, Quantitative Models in Urban Studies, Research Methods in Urban Planning, Urban Geography, Urban Economics, Regional Planning, Urban Transportation Planning, and Application of Surveying in Urban Planning	Sep 2010

AWARDS

Barrett-Campbell Graduate Scholarship , University of New Mexico	2025
Austrian Marshall Plan Foundation Award , 75th Annual Marshall Plan Conference, Vienna, Austria	2022
Best Student Award , University of Kurdistan, Iran — Ranked 2nd among 27 students in BSc Urban Planning	2010

EXPERIENCE

GIS Analyst , David Jacobs, Albuquerque, NM - Performed geocoding, linear referencing, and spatial analysis of traffic crash datasets - Developed interactive web maps and automated GIS workflows to improve data processing efficiency - Produced high-quality static and dynamic visualizations for reports and presentations	2025 – Present
Student Assistant , Gernot Paulus, Villach, Austria - Collected, processed, and validated geospatial data for regional data capture initiatives - Supported database management and quality control for large-scale spatial datasets	202 – 2023
Urban Development Engineer , Kurdistan Province Construction Engineering Organization, Sanandaj, Iran - Supported urban planning and development projects through spatial analysis and engineering design - Prepared technical maps and reports to inform infrastructure and land-use decisions	2019 – 2020
Spatial Data Analyst , Gostaresh Fawaye Danesh Shahr (ICT Smart Cities), Tehran, Iran - Conducted spatial data analysis to support smart city initiatives and ICT-based urban solutions - Assisted in developing geospatial datasets and analytical reports for urban planning projects	2016 – 2018

LEADERSHIP & EXTRACURRICULARS

Board Member , Animal Welfare Charity, Sanandaj, Iran - Contributed to organizational decision-making and coordinated community outreach initiatives - Supported planning and implementation of animal welfare programs	2018 - 2020
Member , Kurdistan Organization for Engineering Order of Building (Urban Planning), Sanandaj, Iran - Maintained professional accreditation and engaged in urban planning standards and practices	2018 – Present

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Skills:

- Analytic Platform: PostgreSQL, FME, Neo4J, KNIM, Google Earth Engine (GEE)
- Programming languages: Python, jQuery, JavaScript, JSON, CSS, HTML, Bootstrap, Github,
- Interactive web map development
- Geographical Information System: ArcGIS, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GRASS, GeoDa, TerrSet, eCognition
- Data Visualization Platform: ESRI City Engine, Auto Desk AutoCAD, ScetchUp

Spoken languages: English, Farsi, Kurdish, German

PUBLICATIONS

Sarafi, S., Lippitt, C.D., & Paulus, G., *Landcover Change and Urban Heat in a Warming Climate: A Global Satellite Perspective*

in preparation